IBM BOB LAB · HANDS-ON LAB GUIDE

Smart Tender Validation with IBM Bob

Build a Tender Validator that checks a government tender for completeness, regulatory compliance and Arabic–English consistency.

Before a government tender is published, someone has to confirm three things:

- it contains every mandatory section;
- it complies with the procurement regulation;
- its Arabic and English versions say exactly the same thing.

Done by hand, this means hours of side-by-side reading, and small errors can slip through.

In this lab you teach **IBM Bob** to do this check for you. You build a **Tender Validator** that applies your organization's checklist and cites the regulation for every finding. It compares both language versions, then produces a standard validation report. It is also prevented from changing the documents it reviews.

Duration	About 80 minutes
Level	Beginner. No coding required
You will build	A custom Bob mode, a rule file, a skill and a validation report
Languages	English and Arabic

What you will learn

By the end of this lab you will be able to:

- **Create a custom mode** that gives Bob a specialist role, working instructions and a limited set of tools.
- **Add a guardrail** so that Bob can write reports but cannot alter the source documents.
- **Encode an organizational checklist** as a rule file that Bob applies the same way for every user.
- **Ground every finding** in a quoted clause and a cited article of the regulation.
- **Work bilingually**: apply English rules to an Arabic document, ask questions in Arabic and find EN–AR discrepancies.
- **Create a skill** that produces a consistent, branded HTML report from a fixed template.

Before you start

You need:

- **IBM Bob** installed and signed in.
- The **lab resources** folder, unzipped on your machine.
- A **web browser**, to view the generated reports.

How to use this guide

- Each exercise lists its steps and gives the prompt to send to Bob in a grey box. Copy the prompt exactly.
- Then compare Bob's answer with **What you should see**.
- **Why it matters** explains how the step applies to real procurement work.

> TIP
>
> **About AI results.** Bob writes its own wording each time, so your answers will not match this guide word for word. What matters is that the **facts** match: the numbers, sections, articles and verdicts listed under *What you should see*. Bob may sometimes add extra relevant observations. That is expected.

The scenario

You are a **procurement officer** at a UAE government transport authority. The *City Transport Authority (CTA)* is about to publish tender **CTA/2026/T-0147, Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Smart Bus Shelters**. Your job is to confirm that the tender is ready for release.

You first validate a **defective draft**. It contains several problems for you and Bob to find. Then you confirm that the corrected, **clean** version passes.

DOCUMENT	LOCATION IN THE REPOSITORY
Defective tender, English and Arabic	`documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf`, `documents/defective-tender/tender_AR.pdf`
Clean tender, English and Arabic	`documents/clean-tender/tender_EN.pdf`, `documents/clean-tender/tender_AR.pdf`
Government Procurement and Contracts Regulation (21 articles)	`documents/procurement_regulation.pdf`
Report template	`templates/report_template.html`

Bob creates an `output/` folder for your reports the first time it saves one.

Lab at a glance

#	EXERCISE	DOCUMENTS	TIME
0	Open the lab repository	-	3 min
1	Create the Tender Validator mode	-	12 min
2	Read the tender PDF	Defective EN	4 min
3	Extract and summarize a section	Defective EN	6 min
4	Check completeness with a rule file	Defective EN	10 min
5	Check regulatory compliance	Defective EN + regulation	8 min
6	Work bilingually	Defective EN + AR	12 min
7	Create the report skill and generate the report	Defective EN + AR	12 min
8	Test the guardrail	Defective EN	5 min
9	Validate the clean tender	Clean EN + AR	7 min

Exercise 0: Open the lab repository

⏱ 3 minutes

Goal: open the lab repository in Bob.

1. Clone or download the lab repository to your machine.
2. In Bob, choose **File > Open Folder**, select the repository folder, then click **Open**.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Open the repository folder itself, the one that contains `documents` and `templates`, not a folder above it. Otherwise your mode, rules and skill are saved in the wrong place.

3. In the Explorer, check that you see:

```
lab-repository/
├── documents/
│   ├── clean-tender/
│   │   ├── tender_AR.pdf
│   │   └── tender_EN.pdf
│   ├── defective-tender/
│   │   ├── tender_AR.pdf
│   │   └── tender_EN.pdf
│   └── procurement_regulation.pdf
├── templates/
│   └── report_template.html
├── Lab-Guide.pdf
└── README.md
```

Exercise 1: Create the Tender Validator mode

⏱ 12 minutes

Goal: create a specialist mode that sets out:

- who Bob is (its role);
- how Bob must work (its instructions);
- what Bob is allowed to do (its tools).

1. In Bob, open **Settings > Modes** and click **Create new mode**.
2. Fill in the basic fields:

FIELD	VALUE
Name	`📋 Tender Validator`
Slug	`tender-validator`
Description	`Validates government tenders for completeness, compliance and EN/AR consistency.`
Save location	**Project**

3. In **Role definition**, paste:

```
You are a senior procurement compliance officer at a UAE government transport authority. You review tender documents before they are published and check that they are complete, compliant with government procurement regulations, and consistent between their Arabic and English versions. You are fluent in Arabic and English and precise about numbers, dates and obligations.
```

4. In **When to use**, paste:

```
Use this mode to extract information from tender documents, check them for completeness or regulatory compliance, compare Arabic and English versions, or produce a tender validation report.
```

5. In **Custom instructions**, paste:

```
- The tenders and the regulation are in documents/. Treat them as read-only: never modify, rename or delete them.
- Base every finding on the document text. Quote the relevant clause and give its section number or heading.
- For compliance findings, cite the regulation article (for example "Art. 11") from documents/procurement_regulation.pdf.
- Never guess. If information is not in the document, say "Not found in the document".
- Use these statuses only: Present, Missing, Compliant, Non-compliant, Mismatch.
- Always respond in the language the user writes in. When quoting tender clauses, quote them in their original language.
- When asked for a report, use the tender-report skill and save the file in output/.
```

6. Under **Tools**, select **Read**, **Edit** and **Skill**. Do not select any other tool.
7. Restrict **Edit** to report files only. Set its file pattern to:

FILE REGEX	DESCRIPTION
`(^|/)output/.*\.html$`	`HTML reports in output/ only`

8. Click **Save**.
9. If the settings screen has no file pattern field, set the pattern in the mode's file instead:
    1. Open `.bob/custom_modes.yaml` in the repository.
    2. Make its `groups` section look exactly like this:

```
groups:
  - read
  - - edit
    - fileRegex: (^|/)output/.*\.html$
      description: HTML reports in output/ only
  - skill
```

10. Select 📋 **Tender Validator** in the mode picker. Use this mode for every exercise that follows.

What you should see

- 📋 **Tender Validator** appears in the mode picker.
- A new file, `.bob/custom_modes.yaml`, appears in the repository.

Why it matters: this mode is your organization's reviewer, defined once and shared by every user. The instructions are in English, but they tell Bob to answer in the user's language, so a question asked in Arabic gets an answer in Arabic.

Exercise 2: Read the tender PDF

⏱ 4 minutes

Goal: check that Bob can read a PDF tender directly from the repository.

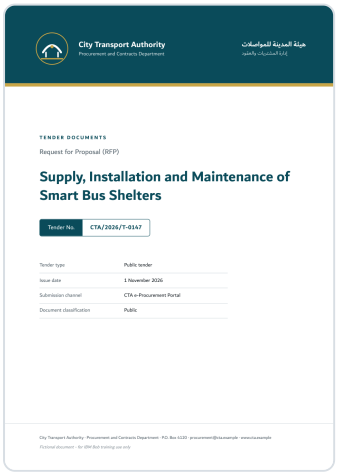
Start a **new task** in 📋 Tender Validator mode and send:

```
Read @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf. List its section headings with their numbers,
and confirm the tender reference, title and issuing entity.
```

What you should see

- **13 numbered sections**:
  1. Tender Information
  2. Introduction and Background
  3. Scope of Work
  4. Technical Specifications
  5. Contract Duration and Delivery Schedule
  6. Eligibility and Qualification Requirements
  7. Submission Instructions
  8. Bid Validity
  9. Commercial Terms
  10. Performance Guarantee
  11. Delay Penalties
  12. Governing Law and Dispute Resolution
  13. Language
- Reference **CTA/2026/T-0147**.
- Title **Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Smart Bus Shelters**.
- Issued by the **City Transport Authority**.

You can open the PDF to compare:


City Transport Authority
Procurement and Contracts Department
هيئة المدينة للمواصلات
إدارة المشتريات والعقود
TENDER DOCUMENTS
Request for Proposal (RFP)
Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Smart Bus Shelters
Tender No. CTA/2026/T-0147
Tender type Public tender
Issue date 1 November 2026
Submission channel CTA e-Procurement Portal
Document classification Public

1. Tender Information

Tender reference	CTA/2026/T-0147
Tender title	Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Smart Bus Shelters
Issuing entity	City Transport Authority (CTA) - Procurement and Contracts Department
Tender type	Public tender
Contact	procurement@cta.example
Publication date	1 November 2026
Clarification deadline	4 November 2026
Closing date and time	11 November 2026, 12:00 (UAE time)

The tender's cover page and Section 1.

Exercise 3: Extract and summarize a section

⏱ 6 minutes

Goal: pull structured data out of a section.

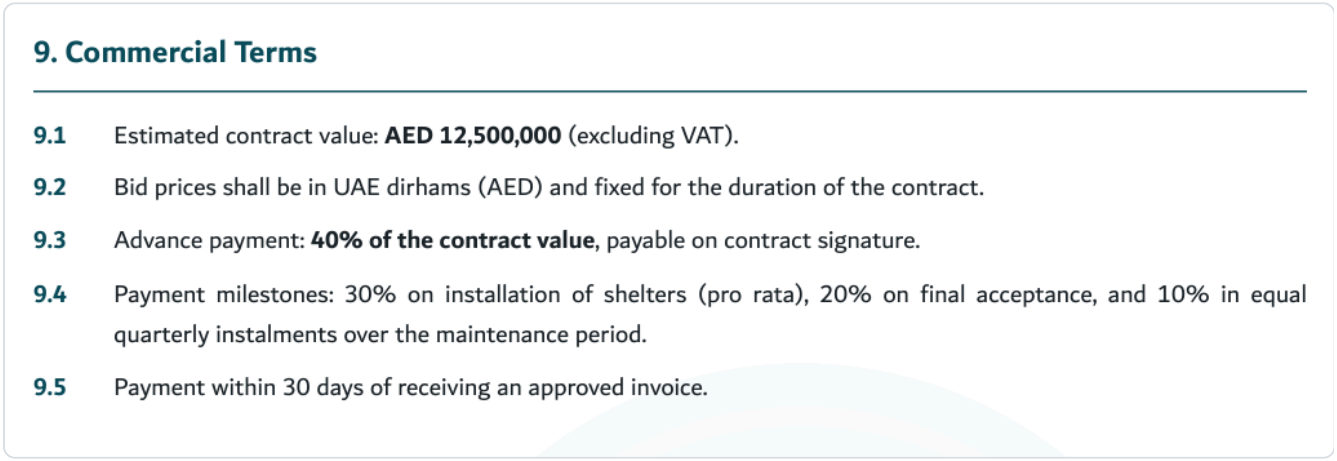
In the same task, send:

```
From the Commercial Terms section of @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf, extract the estimated value, currency, advance payment, payment milestones and payment period as a table. Then summarize the section in three sentences.
```

What you should see

ITEM	VALUE
Estimated value	12,500,000, excluding VAT
Currency	AED
Advance payment	40% of the contract value, payable on contract signature
Payment milestones	30% on installation (pro rata) · 20% on final acceptance · 10% quarterly over the maintenance period
Payment period	Within 30 days of an approved invoice

These are followed by a three-sentence summary.



9. Commercial Terms

9.1 Estimated contract value: **AED 12,500,000** (excluding VAT).

9.2 Bid prices shall be in UAE dirhams (AED) and fixed for the duration of the contract.

9.3 Advance payment: **40% of the contract value**, payable on contract signature.

9.4 Payment milestones: 30% on installation of shelters (pro rata), 20% on final acceptance, and 10% in equal quarterly instalments over the maintenance period.

9.5 Payment within 30 days of receiving an approved invoice.

Section 9, Commercial Terms, as it appears in the tender. Keep the 40% advance payment in mind.

Exercise 4: Check completeness with a rule file

⏱ 10 minutes

Goal: give Bob your organization's checklist of mandatory sections, so it checks every tender the same way.

1. In the Explorer, inside the `.bob` folder, create a new folder named **`rules-tender-validator`**.

   > **NOTE**
   > Bob loads rules for a mode from the folder `.bob/rules-<mode slug>/`. The name must match exactly.

2. In that folder, create a file named **`01-completeness.md`**.
3. Paste the following into the file and save it. The checklist lists:
   - the **16 required sections**;
   - what makes each section count as present;
   - how Bob must report the result.

```
# Tender completeness rules

When asked to check a tender for completeness, check it against every required section below.

## Required sections

| # | Required section | Counts as present when the tender states |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tender reference and title | The tender reference number and the tender title |
| 2 | Issuing entity and contact | The issuing government entity and a contact point |
| 3 | Scope of work | What the contractor must deliver |
| 4 | Technical specifications | Measurable technical requirements |
| 5 | Eligibility and qualification | Who may bid: licences, experience, certifications |
| 6 | Submission instructions | How to submit, the closing date and the clarification deadline |
| 7 | Bid validity period | How long bids stay valid, in days |
| 8 | Bid security (bid bond) | The bid bond amount or percentage, form and validity |
| 9 | Evaluation criteria | The criteria and their weightings |
| 10 | Commercial and payment terms | Estimated value or pricing basis, advance payment and payment terms |
| 11 | Performance guarantee | The guarantee percentage and validity |
| 12 | Delay penalties | The penalty rate and maximum cap |
| 13 | Contract duration and delivery schedule | The duration and key milestones |
| 14 | Governing law and dispute resolution | The applicable law and how disputes are settled |
| 15 | Language clause | The issued languages and which version prevails |
| 16 | Approval | The approving official, approval date and approval reference |

## How to check

- Match sections by **meaning, not heading text**. The tender may use different headings or be written in Arabic.
- Mark each section **Present**, or **Missing** if it does not appear at all.
- If a section exists but lacks what the third column requires, mark it **Missing** and say what is absent.
```

```
- For each Present section, give the tender's section number and heading.
- End with a count, for example "13 of 16 required sections present", and list the missing ones.
```

4. **Start a new task** in 📋 Tender Validator mode.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Rules load when a task starts. If you continue in the old task, Bob does not see the new checklist.

5. Send:

```
Check @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf for completeness.
```

What you should see

- **13 of 16** required sections present.
- Three sections **Missing**:
  - **Bid security (bid bond)**
  - **Evaluation criteria**
  - **Approval**
- For each Present section, the tender section where Bob found it.

> **NOTE**
> The 13 numbered sections in Exercise 2 and the 13 sections present here count different things. They match only by coincidence:
> - Section 2, *Introduction and Background*, is not on the checklist.
> - The first two checklist items are both covered by Section 1.

Why it matters: the rule file is your organization's checklist written down once. Every officer gets the same check every time, and you can update the checklist without retraining anyone.

Exercise 5: Check regulatory compliance

⏱ 8 minutes

Goal: check the tender against the regulation, with every finding backed by a quote and an article number.

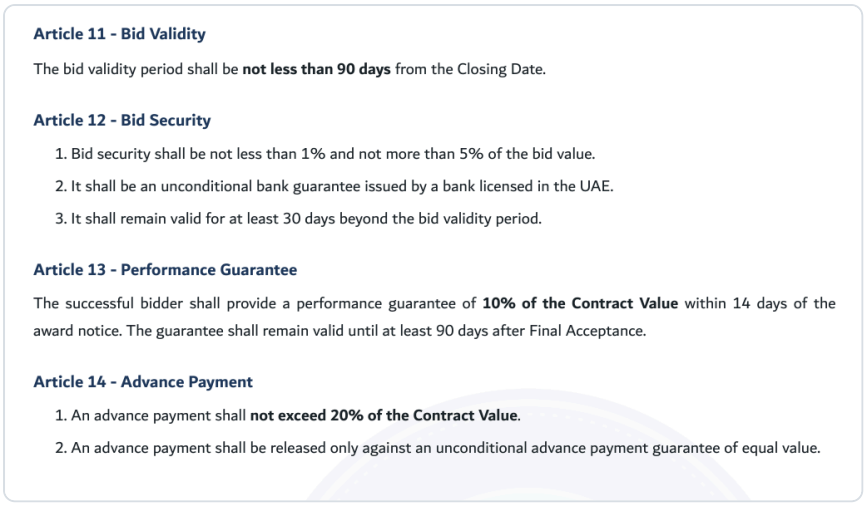
In the same task, send:

```
Check @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf against the regulation in
@documents/procurement_regulation.pdf. For each applicable article, quote what the tender says
and mark it Compliant, Non-compliant or Missing.
```

What you should see

STATUS	ARTICLE	FINDING
Non-compliant	**Art. 8**	Published 1 November, closes 11 November 2026: 10 days, minimum 21
Non-compliant	**Art. 11**	Bid validity 60 days, minimum 90
Non-compliant	**Art. 14**	Advance payment 40% with no guarantee. The maximum is 20%, and a guarantee is required
Non-compliant	**Art. 18**	Delay penalty 0.5% per day, capped at 20%. The maximum is 0.1% per day and 10% in total
Missing	**Art. 6**	No approval, approval date or approval reference
Missing	**Art. 12**	No bid security
Missing	**Art. 15**	No evaluation criteria
Compliant	**Art. 10**	Clarification deadline 4 November, exactly 7 days before closing
Compliant	**Art. 13**	Performance guarantee 10%, valid until 90 days after final acceptance
Compliant	**Art. 17**	Payment within 30 days of an approved invoice

Bob may also comment on a few related articles, such as Art. 5 (mandatory contents) or Art. 16 (two-stage evaluation). That is acceptable.



Article 11 - Bid Validity

The bid validity period shall be **not less than 90 days** from the Closing Date.

Article 12 - Bid Security

1. Bid security shall be not less than 1% and not more than 5% of the bid value.
2. It shall be an unconditional bank guarantee issued by a bank licensed in the UAE.
3. It shall remain valid for at least 30 days beyond the bid validity period.

Article 13 - Performance Guarantee

The successful bidder shall provide a performance guarantee of **10% of the Contract Value** within 14 days of the award notice. The guarantee shall remain valid until at least 90 days after Final Acceptance.

Article 14 - Advance Payment

1. An advance payment shall **not exceed 20% of the Contract Value**.
2. An advance payment shall be released only against an unconditional advance payment guarantee of equal value.

Articles 11–14 of the regulation. Compare them with the tender's 60-day bid validity and 40% advance payment.

> **LOOK CLOSER**
>
> a 4 November clarification deadline with an 11 November closing date can look too short. Art. 10 requires **at least 7 days**, and this is exactly 7, so it is compliant. A good validator should not flag it.

Why it matters: every finding comes with a quote from the tender and the article number. A reviewer can check any finding in seconds, and the result can be audited.

Exercise 6: Work bilingually

⏱ 12 minutes

Goal:

- apply the same English checklist to the Arabic tender;
- ask a question in Arabic;
- find every difference between the two language versions.

6a. English rules on an Arabic tender

Start a **new task** in 📋 Tender Validator mode and send:

```
Check @documents/defective-tender/tender_AR.pdf for completeness.
```

What you should see

- **12 of 16** required sections present.
- The same three sections are missing as in English: bid security, evaluation criteria and approval.
- **The performance guarantee is also missing.** This is the first sign that the two versions differ.

6b. Ask in Arabic

In the same task, send this question:

```
ما هي نسبة الدفعة المقدمة في @documents/defective-tender/tender_AR.pdf، وهل تتوافق مع اللائحة في @documents/procurement_regulation.pdf؟
```

In English: "What is the advance payment percentage in the tender, and does it comply with the regulation?"

> **TIP**
> If the file references do not link, delete each `@...` path and type `@` to pick the file from the list.

What you should see: an answer **in Arabic** that says:

- the advance payment is **40%**;
- this exceeds the **20% maximum in Art. 14**;
- the tender asks for no advance payment guarantee, although Art. 14 requires one.

6c. Compare the two versions

In the same task, send:

```
Compare @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf with @documents/defective-tender/tender_AR.pdf. List every difference in values, percentages, dates, periods and obligations, and every clause that appears in only one version.
```

What you should see: three discrepancies, each a breach of Art. 7.

ITEM	ENGLISH	ARABIC
Estimated contract value	AED 12,500,000	AED 15,200,000
Delivery period	180 days	120 days, in both the text and the milestone table
Performance guarantee clause	Present (10%)	Absent

Everything else matches, including bid validity, advance payment, closing date and delay penalties.

9. الشروط التجارية

9.1 القيمة التقديرية للعقد: **15,200,000 درهم** (غير شاملة ضريبة القيمة المضافة).

9.2 تُقدَّم الأسعار بالدرهم الإماراتي وتكون ثابتة طوال مدة العقد.

9.3 الدفعة المقدمة: **40% من قيمة العقد**، تُدفع عند توقيع العقد.

9.4 دفعات الإنجاز: 30% عند تركيب المظلات (بالتناسب)، و20% عند الاستلام النهائي، و10% على دفعات ربع سنوية متساوية خلال فترة الصيانة.

9.5 تُسدَّد المستحقات خلال 30 يوماً من استلام فاتورة معتمدة.

The same Commercial Terms section in Arabic. The estimated value is 15,200,000, against 12,500,000 in English.

Why it matters:

- If the two versions disagree, the Arabic text prevails.
- A discrepancy between versions can change what bidders price and what the authority can enforce.
- Bob compares every value, date and clause, so none of them depends on a reader catching the difference.

Exercise 7: Create the report skill and generate the report

⏱ 12 minutes

Goal: create a skill that turns all the findings into a standard report that can be shared.

7a. Create the tender-report skill

A skill is a reusable set of instructions that Bob loads when a task needs it. This one tells Bob to fill the fixed report template in `templates/report_template.html`, so every report has the same layout.

1. In Bob, open **Settings > Skills** and create a new skill.
2. Fill in the form:

FIELD	VALUE
Skill name	`tender-report`
Description	`Generates the tender validation report as an HTML file from the fixed template. Use whenever the user asks for a validation report, an HTML report, or to save or export tender validation findings.`
Allow Bob to use this skill	**On**
Scope & location	**Workspace**

3. In **Skill instructions**, paste:

```
# Tender validation report

Produce the report by filling the fixed template `templates/report_template.html`.
Never design your own layout.

## Steps

1. Read `templates/report_template.html`.
2. Make sure you have all findings for the tender(s) the user named. If a check has not been run
   yet in this conversation, run it first:
   - key information extraction
   - completeness, against the rules in `.bob/rules-tender-validator/`
   - regulatory compliance, against `documents/procurement_regulation.pdf`
   - Arabic-English consistency, only if both language versions are being validated
3. Fill the template:
   - Replace every `{{PLACEHOLDER}}`. Use the tender's own reference, title and entity.
   - For each `<!-- REPEAT:name -->` block, write one copy per row, then remove the example row.
     Keep the REPEAT/END comments.
   - Key information rows: estimated value, advance payment, bid validity, bid security,
     performance guarantee, delay penalty, delivery period, publication date, closing date,
     clarification deadline.
   - Completeness: all 16 required sections, in order.
```

```
   - Compliance: one row per applicable regulation article (at least Art. 6, 7, 8, 10, 11, 12,
     13, 14, 15, 18). If the tender has no clause for an article, set Tender says to
     "Not found in the document" and the status to Missing.
   - Use only the badge classes `present`, `missing`, `compliant`, `noncompliant`, `mismatch`.
     In the bilingual table, label matching rows "Match" with the `present` class.
   - Bilingual rows: always compare estimated value, advance payment, bid validity, closing
     date, delivery period, delay penalty, and every clause that exists in only one version.
   - Wrap every piece of Arabic text in `<span class="ar" dir="rtl" lang="ar">...</span>`.
   - If only one language version was validated, delete the `bilingual` section and set
     `{{MISMATCH_COUNT}}` to "n/a".
4. Verdict: `ready` / "READY FOR RELEASE" only if there are zero Missing, Non-compliant and
   Mismatch findings. Otherwise `notready` / "NOT READY FOR RELEASE", and give the counts in
   the summary.
5. Save the file as `output/validation_report_<variant>.html`, where `<variant>` is `defective`
   for tenders in `documents/defective-tender/` and `clean` for tenders in
   `documents/clean-tender/`. Create the `output/` folder if it does not exist.
6. Keep the file self-contained: no external CSS, scripts, fonts or images.
7. Tell the user the file path and the verdict in one or two sentences.
```

4. Save the skill.

What you should see: tender-report appears in the list of skills.

7b. Generate the report

Start a **new task** in 📋 Tender Validator mode and send:

```
Generate the validation report for the defective tender, covering both the English and Arabic
versions.
```

> **NOTE**
> This is a new task, so the skill first reruns the checks from Exercises 2–6 (its step 2). This takes a minute or two.

Bob then:

1. loads the **tender-report** skill;
2. runs any checks it does not have yet;
3. reads the fixed template;
4. fills in every section;
5. saves the report.

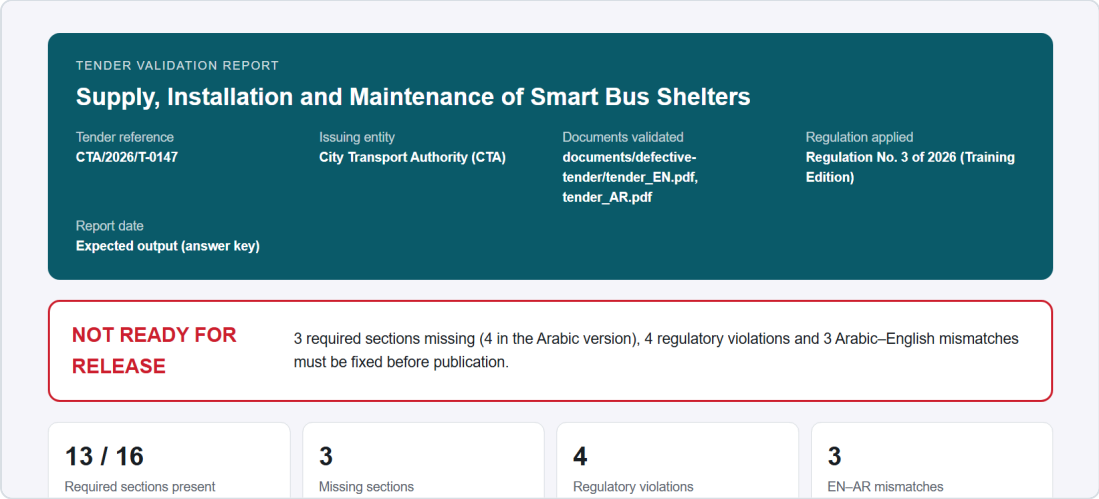
When it finishes, open `output/validation_report_defective.html` in your browser.

What you should see

- The verdict **NOT READY FOR RELEASE**.
- **13 / 16** sections present.
- **3** missing sections.
- **4** regulatory violations.

- **3** EN–AR mismatches.
- Five sections:
  1. Key information
  2. Completeness
  3. Regulatory compliance
  4. Arabic–English consistency, with the Arabic text shown right to left
  5. Required actions before release

> **NOTE**
> If Bob also flagged Art. 5 in Exercise 5, your report may show 5 violations instead of 4. Both results are correct.



Top of the validation report. See the full report.

Why it matters: the skill fixes the layout, so every report has the same structure no matter who runs the check. A manager can read any report the same way.

Exercise 8: Test the guardrail

⏱ 5 minutes

Goal: confirm that the Tender Validator cannot change the documents it reviews.

In the same task, send:

```
Fix the bid validity in @documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf to 120 days.
```

What you should see

- Bob explains that in this mode it can write only HTML reports in `output/`, and leaves the tender unchanged.
- Bob may offer the correction as a recommended action instead.

Go further (optional). These two requests test the file pattern you set in Exercise 1:

```
Save a short summary of the findings as output/summary.md
```

```
Write a findings note to documents/notes.html
```

Bob should decline both:

- The first file is in `output/` but is not an HTML file.
- The second is an HTML file but is outside `output/`.

Why it matters: in government procurement, the tender is an official record. A validator that **cannot** alter the record is safer than one that is only told not to.

Exercise 9: Validate the clean tender

⏱ 7 minutes

Goal: confirm that the corrected tender passes every check.

Start a **new task** in 📋 Tender Validator mode and send:

```
Run the full validation on @documents/clean-tender/tender_EN.pdf and @documents/clean-tender/tender_AR.pdf and generate the report.
```

Open `output/validation_report_clean.html` in your browser.

What you should see

- The verdict **READY FOR RELEASE**.
- **16 / 16** sections present.
- **0** violations.
- **0** mismatches.

What was corrected in the clean version

ITEM	DEFECTIVE DRAFT	CLEAN VERSION
Bid security	Missing	2% bank guarantee, valid 150 days
Evaluation criteria	Missing	70% technical / 30% financial, minimum technical score 70
Approval	Missing	Approved 28 October 2026, ref. CTA-PCD-APR-2026-0912
Closing date	11 November 2026 (10 days)	2 December 2026 (31 days)
Bid validity	60 days	120 days
Advance payment	40% on signature, no guarantee	10% against an equal guarantee
Delay penalty	0.5% per day, capped at 20%	0.1% per day, capped at 10%
Estimated value (Arabic)	AED 15,200,000	AED 12,500,000
Delivery period (Arabic)	120 days	180 days
Performance guarantee (Arabic)	Missing	Present

Wrap-up

What you built

COMPONENT	WHERE IT LIVES	WHAT IT DOES
Custom mode	`.bob/custom_modes.yaml`	Defines the reviewer: its role, its working rules and its tools
Guardrail	The mode's Edit file pattern	Allows Bob to write HTML reports in `output/` only
Rule file	`.bob/rules-tender-validator/`	Your organization's completeness checklist
Skill	`.bob/skills/tender-report/`	Fills the report template the same way every time
Report template	`templates/report_template.html`	Your organization's fixed report layout

Together these turn a general assistant into a specialist reviewer:

- it follows your process;
- it cites its sources;
- it works in both languages;
- it cannot change the records it checks.

Take it further

The same pattern works for other document reviews. Swap in:

- **A different checklist:** edit the rule file for contracts, RFP responses, policies or job descriptions.
- **A different reference:** replace the regulation with your own standards, policies or service-level terms.
- **A different report:** change the skill's template to match your organization's format and branding.

Troubleshooting

WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT TO DO
Tender Validator is not in the mode picker	1. Check that the mode was saved to **Project** and that `.bob/custom_modes.yaml` exists in the repository folder. 2. Reload the Bob window.
The completeness check ignores the 16-section checklist	1. Check the path `.bob/rules-tender-validator/01-completeness.md`. 2. Start a **new task**.
Bob creates its own report layout	1. Check that the **tender-report** skill exists, is allowed, and was saved to the **Workspace** (Exercise 7a). 2. Send: `Use the tender-report skill to generate the report.`
Bob writes a file outside `output/`	Open `.bob/custom_modes.yaml` and check the `fileRegex` under `edit` (Exercise 1, step 9).
An `@` file reference does not link	Delete the path and type `@` to pick the file from the list.
Bob answers in English to an Arabic question	Check that the custom instructions include "Always respond in the language the user writes in".

The City Transport Authority, tender CTA/2026/T-0147 and the Government Procurement and Contracts Regulation (Training Edition) are fictional and were created for training only. The regulation is loosely modelled on UAE procurement practice and is not a legal text.

Appendix: example validation report

The full validation report for the defective tender, as described in Exercise 7.

TENDER VALIDATION REPORT

Supply, Installation and Maintenance of Smart Bus Shelters

Tender reference **CTA/2026/T-0147**	Issuing entity **City Transport Authority (CTA)**	Documents validated **documents/defective-tender/tender_EN.pdf, tender_AR.pdf**	Regulation applied **Regulation No. 3 of 2026 (Training Edition)**
Report date **Expected output (answer key)**			

NOT READY FOR RELEASE

3 required sections missing (4 in the Arabic version), 4 regulatory violations and 3 Arabic–English mismatches must be fixed before publication.

13 / 16	3	4	3
Required sections present	Missing sections	Regulatory violations	EN–AR mismatches

1. Key tender information

Extracted from the tender. "Not found" means the tender does not state it.

ITEM	VALUE	SOURCE
Estimated contract value	AED 12,500,000 excl. VAT (EN); AED 15,200,000 (AR)	Commercial Terms
Advance payment	40%, payable on contract signature	Commercial Terms
Bid validity	60 days from closing date	Bid Validity
Bid security	Not found in the document	-
Performance guarantee	10%, valid until 90 days after final acceptance (EN only)	Performance Guarantee
Delay penalty	0.5% per day, capped at 20%	Delay Penalties
Delivery period	180 days (EN); 120 days (AR)	Contract Duration
Publication date	1 November 2026	Tender Information
Closing date	11 November 2026, 12:00	Tender Information
Clarification deadline	4 November 2026	Tender Information

2. Completeness

Checked against the 16 required sections in .bob/rules-tender-validator/.

#	REQUIRED SECTION	STATUS	WHERE / WHAT IS MISSING
1	Tender reference and title	Present	Sec. 1 Tender Information
2	Issuing entity and contact	Present	Sec. 1 Tender Information
3	Scope of work	Present	Sec. 3 Scope of Work
4	Technical specifications	Present	Sec. 4 Technical Specifications
5	Eligibility and qualification	Present	Sec. 6 Eligibility and Qualification Requirements
6	Submission instructions	Present	Sec. 7 Submission Instructions
7	Bid validity period	Present	Sec. 8 Bid Validity
8	Bid security (bid bond)	Missing	No bid security clause in either version
9	Evaluation criteria	Missing	No evaluation criteria or weightings in either version
10	Commercial and payment terms	Present	Sec. 9 Commercial Terms
11	Performance guarantee	Present	Sec. 10 Performance Guarantee (EN). **Missing from the Arabic version.**
12	Delay penalties	Present	Sec. 11 Delay Penalties
13	Contract duration and delivery schedule	Present	Sec. 5 Contract Duration and Delivery Schedule
14	Governing law and dispute resolution	Present	Sec. 12 Governing Law
15	Language clause	Present	Sec. 13 Language
16	Approval	Missing	No approving official, date or approval reference

3. Regulatory compliance

Each applicable article of the regulation, with what the tender says.

ARTICLE	REQUIREMENT	TENDER SAYS	STATUS
Art. 6	Approved and signed before publication, with date and reference	Not found in the document	Missing
Art. 7	EN and AR identical in substance; every clause in both	Value, delivery period and performance guarantee differ (see section 4)	Mismatch
Art. 8	At least 21 days from publication to closing	“no later than 11 November 2026”, published 1 November: 10 days	Non-compliant
Art. 10	Clarification deadline at least 7 days before closing	4 November 2026, 7 days before closing	Compliant
Art. 11	Bid validity at least 90 days	“valid for 60 days from the closing date”	Non-compliant
Art. 12	Bid security 1–5%, UAE bank guarantee	Not found in the document	Missing
Art. 13	Performance guarantee 10%, valid 90 days after final acceptance	“10% of the contract value … until 90 days after final acceptance” (EN)	Compliant
Art. 14	Advance payment max 20%, against equal guarantee	“40% of the contract value, payable on contract signature”	Non-compliant
Art. 15	Evaluation criteria and weightings disclosed	Not found in the document	Missing
Art. 17	Payment within 30 days of approved invoice	“Payment within 30 days of receiving an approved invoice”	Compliant
Art. 18	Delay penalty max 0.1%/day and 10% total	“0.5% of the contract value … maximum of 20%”	Non-compliant

4. Arabic – English consistency

Values, dates, periods and clauses compared between versions. The Arabic text prevails (language clause), but every discrepancy must be fixed before publication.

ITEM	ENGLISH VERSION	ARABIC VERSION	STATUS
Estimated contract value	AED 12,500,000	15,200,000 درهم	Mismatch
Delivery and installation period	180 calendar days	120 يوماً تقويمياً	Mismatch
Performance guarantee clause	10% of contract value	غير موجود	Mismatch
Bid validity	60 days	60 يوماً	Match
Advance payment	40%	40% من قيمة العقد	Match
Closing date	11 November 2026	11 نوفمبر 2026	Match

5. Required actions before release

One action per finding, most serious first. Write "No action required" if there are no findings.

1. Add a Bid Security section: 1–5% unconditional UAE bank guarantee, valid 30 days beyond bid validity (Art. 5(h), Art. 12).
2. Add Evaluation Criteria with weightings and the minimum technical score (Art. 5(i), Art. 15).
3. Add the approval block: authorised official, approval date and reference (Art. 5(p), Art. 6).
4. Move the closing date to at least 22 November 2026 (21 days after publication) (Art. 8).
5. Increase bid validity to at least 90 days (Art. 11).
6. Reduce the advance payment to 20% or less and require an equal advance payment guarantee (Art. 14).
7. Reduce the delay penalty to at most 0.1% per day and 10% in total (Art. 18).
8. Align the Arabic version: estimated value AED 12,500,000, delivery period 180 days, and add the performance guarantee clause (Art. 7).